Devil facial tumour disease

☞ **1** Use the notes below to write a paragraph on devil facial tumour disease.



- Tasmanian devils are **endangered**
- many suffer from devil facial tumour disease (DFTD)
- DFTD is a rare **contagious** cancer
- starts as small lumps and cuts around the mouth
- develop into large **tumours** around the face and neck
- tumours spread throughout the body
- infected devils can't eat properly; they weaken and die
- spread by infected devils biting other devils
- sightings of devils have declined by over 80% since DFTD was first noted in the 1990s

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2 Why would a Tasmanian devil bite another devil? _____

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3 Write whether the following statements are true or false.

a) Tasmanian devil numbers have declined rapidly. _____

b) DFTD is spread by coughing. _____

c) DFTD is a virus. _____

d) Many devils starve to death because they can't eat. _____

e) All cancers are contagious. _____

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